

Xiaochuan Li

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Formal and experimental semantics, psycholinguistics, language models. Current focus: epistemic modality.

EDUCATION

University of Technology Nuremberg <i>M.Sc. Human and Artificial Intelligence</i> Coursework: cognitive psychology, experimental design and statistics, interpretability, deep learning.	Nuremberg, Germany <i>Oct. 2025 – exp. 2027</i>
University of Marburg <i>Preparatory studies: German for graduate study</i>	Marburg, Germany <i>2024 – 2025</i>
Shenzhen University <i>B.A. Philosophy</i> Thesis: Leibniz’s characteristic universalis (supervisor: Zang Yong).	Shenzhen, China <i>2020 – 2024</i>

RESEARCH

CURRENT · EPISTEMIC MODALITY

Three Ways of Leaving p Unsettled <i>Formal semantics and pragmatics · analysis in development</i> Compares might p, might p or might not p, and I don’t know whether p by the replies each licenses.	<i>2026 –</i>
Modal language in preschool children <i>M.Sc. thesis · in planning</i> A small study run alongside an existing study of how preschool children reason about possibilities.	<i>2026 –</i>
Modal expressions in language models <i>Language-model study · in development</i> Diagnostics of how models treat ruled-out possibilities; a cognitive account and internal tests are planned.	<i>2026 –</i>

EARLIER

Fact-checking after ChatGPT exposure <i>Course study, Foundations in Psychology and Empirical Study Design</i> Between-subjects experiment (N = 49), group-designed and adopted for the class-wide study; my part: data analysis.	<i>Winter 2025–26</i>
Cross-lingual ProtoBias <i>Single-author course project</i> Evaluation of two VLM families across seven prompt languages, about 12,600 judgments. report · code	<i>Summer 2026</i>
Street-view country classification <i>Team course project, Deep Learning</i> My part: CNN training, ablations, and performance analysis.	<i>Summer 2026</i>

PAPERS AND MANUSCRIPTS

Li, X. (2026). Typicality in referent choice: What the description leaves open. Working paper. lingbuzz/010343, doi:10.5281/zenodo.22855036

Prompt framing and latent control states in language models. Manuscript in preparation, with collaborators at DFKI.

EMPLOYMENT

University of Technology Nuremberg <i>IT Service Desk (part-time)</i> Designed and delivered IT onboarding training for incoming students, with follow-up one-to-one support; also system installation, service reporting, and inventory.	Nuremberg, Germany <i>Apr. 2026 – present</i>
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SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Programming	Python (PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers, pandas, scikit-learn), Git, LaTeX
Methods	PsychoPy/Pavlovia, JASP; probing, activation patching, steering (working proficiency)
Languages	Mandarin Chinese (native), German (C1), English (C1), Japanese (learning)